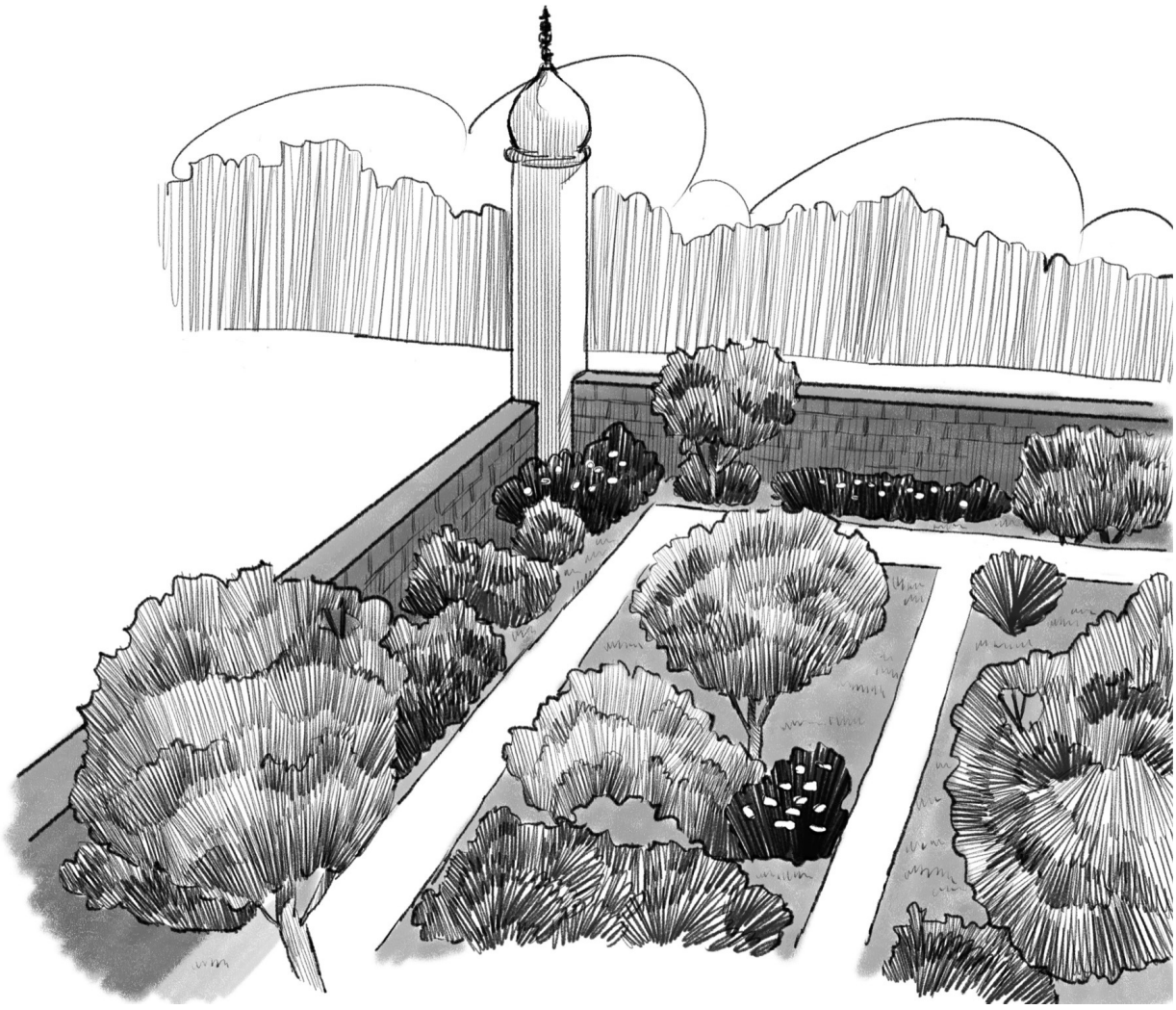


This was a “moonlight garden,” where the view of the Taj Mahal was best at night. The Yamuna River itself was part of this view, reflecting the light of the moon. The dome of the Taj Mahal, even today, shines brightly in the full moon. The flowers that were planted on this side were mostly white ones. They were chosen because they released their aroma at night.

This discovery proved that the mausoleum was exactly halfway between the end of this garden and the entrance to the whole complex. Just as people had suspected, the mausoleum itself was intended to be the center of a single huge monument.

Today, the night garden across the river, like the one at the Taj Mahal entrance, is being restored. There are eighty-one different kinds of flowers, all known to have been favorites of the Moguls. At night, Shah Jahan liked to view the monument from here.